

Day 2 — Tulasī — Holy Basil

Module: Herbs — Auśadhi · **Band:** Senior · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will: identify tulasī by leaf and smell; name the active compound (eugenol).

Materials

- Whiteboard / chart paper
- Notebook, pen per student
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

Vocabulary introduced today

- *tulasī* (IAST: tulasī; lit. “holy basil — *Ocimum tenuiflorum*”)

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- Daily check-in: one-sentence response to “*What’s one thing you remember about yesterday’s lesson?*”
- Hook: introduce a phenomenon or question that motivates today’s concept.

Core (20 min)

1. **Botanical identification.** *Ocimum tenuiflorum* (also *O. sanctum*). Square stem, opposite leaves with serrated edges, distinctive aromatic oil glands. Multiple cultivars: *Rama tulasī* (green), *Kṛṣṇa tulasī* (purple), *Vana tulasī* (wild).
2. **Active compound.** Eugenol (60-70% of essential oil), ursolic acid, rosmarinic acid. Some research on adaptogenic / anti-inflammatory effects (Cohen, 2014 — *Journal of Ayurveda and Integrative Medicine*).
3. **Traditional uses.** Caraka and Suśruta cite *tulasī* for: cough, cold, low-grade fever, indigestion (in tea form), as a bedside plant for air quality.
4. **Source.** Atharva Veda 10.97 — Auśadhi Sūkta — though not naming *tulasī* specifically, the framing of “herbs as healing beings” begins here. Caraka *Sūtrasthāna* 26 lists *tulasī* formally.
5. **Smell-test demo.** Crush a leaf; pass around. Note clove-like aroma (eugenol). Modern aroma-chemistry: same compound (eugenol) gives cloves their scent.

Activity (15 min)

A scaled version of *Blind Smell-Test Identification* (see [activities/](#)). Today's slice: focus on the part of the activity that reinforces Tulsī — Holy Basil.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- One-sentence exit ticket: “*What’s one thing you learned today?*”
- Preview tomorrow.

Homework

(See `homework.md` for today’s task.)

Differentiation

- **Extension:** offer one open question or extra problem for fast finishers.
- **Support:** pair students who need scaffolds; offer partial outlines.

Teacher notes

- Citations: at least one quoted verse with citation per module. Day 1 already includes one if applicable; you may add more.
- Connect to prior modules where natural (especially Module 2 *pañcabhūta*).